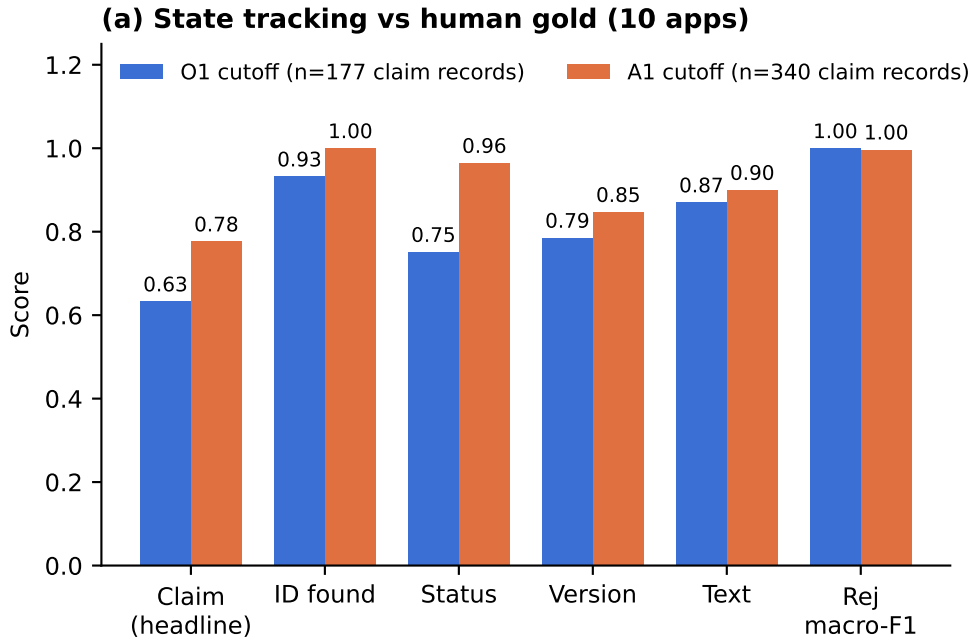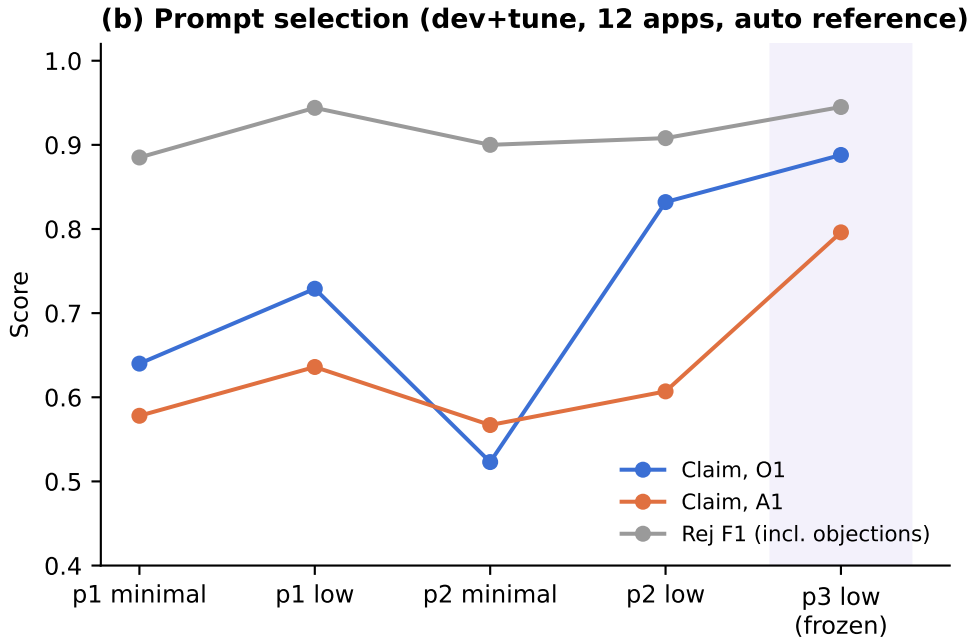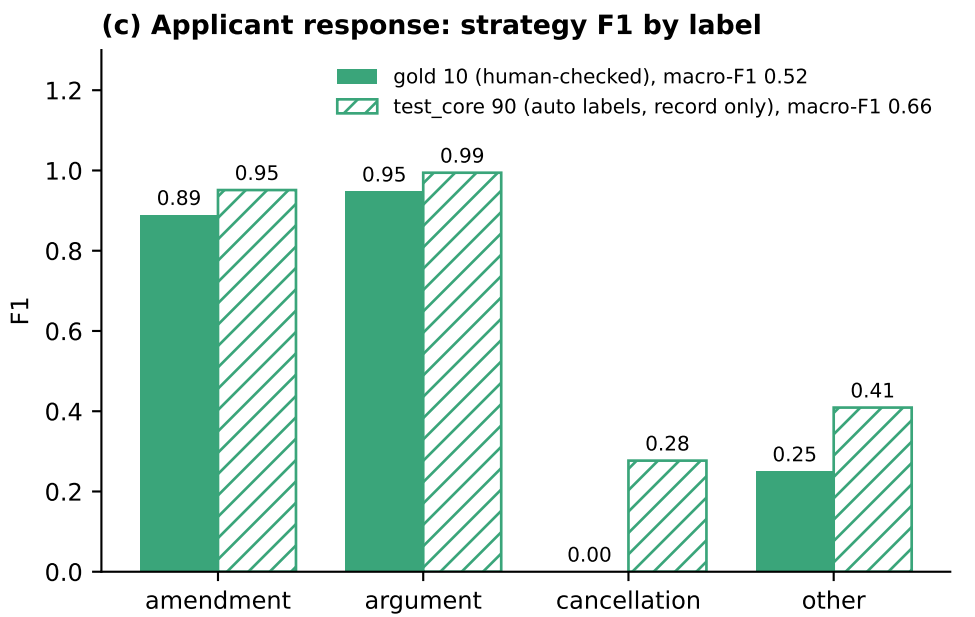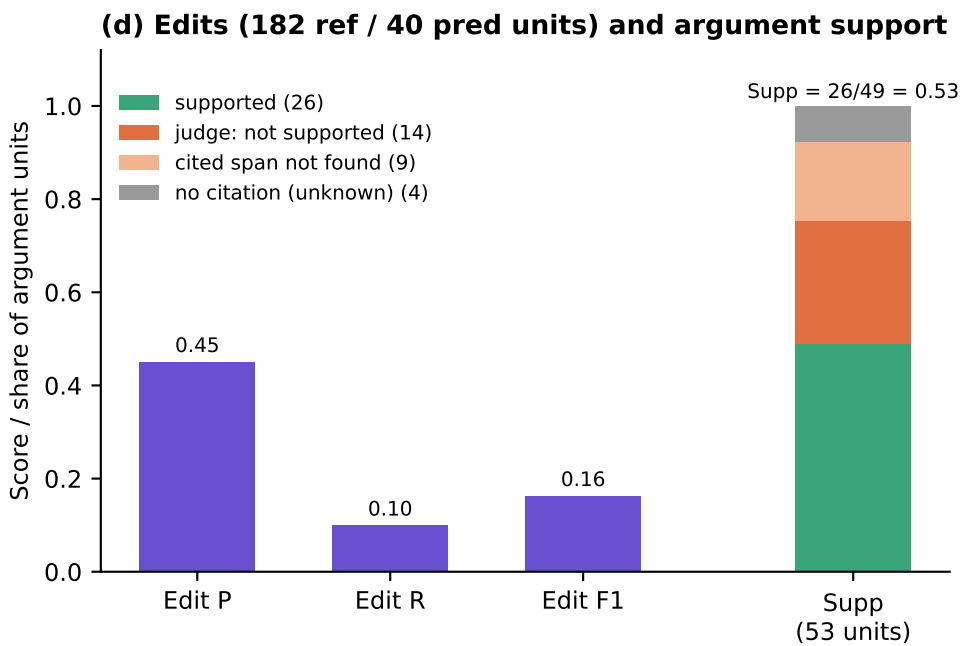A — State Tracking + Applicant Response (gpt-5-mini, reasoning_effort=low; week-3 pilot)